

Password and Access Control Policy

Company Name	TCS (Tera Company Service)
Document Title	Password and Access Control Policy
Policy ID	TCS-IT-004
Version	2.3
Effective Date	01-Jan-2026
Last Updated	20-Jul-2026
Document Owner	Chief Information Security Officer
Department	Information Security
Confidentiality	Internal Use Only

1. Purpose

This policy defines password standards and access control procedures to protect TCS systems and data from unauthorized access.

2. Scope

Applies to all employees, interns, and contractors with credentials to any TCS system, application, or account.

3. Definitions

Privileged Access	Elevated system permissions (e.g., admin rights) beyond standard user access.
Account Lockout	Automatic, temporary disabling of an account after repeated failed login attempts.

4. Password Requirements

All TCS account passwords must meet the following minimum standard:

- At least 12 characters in length.
- Includes at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character.

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- Must not contain the employee's name, Employee ID, or common dictionary words.
 - Must not match any of the last 10 previously used passwords.

Passwords must never be shared, written on physical notes, or stored in unencrypted documents or browsers without a company-approved password manager (1Password Business is provided to all employees).

5. Password Expiration

Passwords for company email and core systems expire every **90 days** and must be changed at that time. Employees receive an automated reminder 7 days before expiration. Privileged access accounts (system administrators) have a shorter expiration cycle of 45 days.

6. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

MFA is mandatory for all employees on email, VPN, and cloud application logins, as detailed in the Cyber Security Policy (TCS-IT-002) and VPN and Remote Access Policy (TCS-IT-003). MFA cannot be disabled by the employee under any circumstance.

7. Account Lockout

An account is automatically locked after **5 consecutive failed login attempts** within a 15-minute window, for a lockout duration of 30 minutes. Employees who are locked out before the timeout expires may request an immediate unlock via the IT Helpdesk, after identity verification.

8. Account Sharing Restrictions

Sharing of login credentials, including passwords, MFA codes, or active sessions, between employees is **strictly prohibited** under all circumstances, including for convenience or coverage during leave. **You may not share your company password with a colleague**, even temporarily; each employee must use only their own credentials. Any business need for shared or delegated access (e.g., a shared team mailbox) must be requested formally through IT and provisioned as a proper shared account with individual audit logging, not via personal password sharing.

9. Access Requests

Access to systems and applications beyond an employee's default provisioning must be requested via the IT Access Request form on the employee portal, specifying the system, business justification, and required duration. Requests are approved by the Reporting Manager and, for sensitive systems, by the relevant System Owner and Information Security team.

10. Access Removal

Access rights are reviewed quarterly by IT Security in coordination with department heads. Access no longer required for an employee's current role (e.g., after an internal transfer) is removed within 5 working days of the role change being recorded in the HR system.

11. Privileged Access

Privileged (administrator-level) access is granted only to designated IT and DevOps personnel based on documented business need, requires additional approval from the CISO's office, and is subject to enhanced monitoring and a shorter password expiration cycle (45 days). Privileged accounts must not be used for routine, non-administrative tasks such as browsing or email.

12. Employee Termination / Access Revocation

Upon an employee's resignation, termination, or last working day, all system access — email, VPN, applications, and building access — is **revoked within 4 hours** of the official exit time recorded by HR. This is coordinated automatically between the HR system and IT Identity Management platform as part of the standard exit checklist.

13. Security Responsibilities

Every employee is responsible for safeguarding their own credentials, reporting suspected compromise immediately to the Security Operations Center, and completing periodic security training as required under the Training and Learning Policy (TCS-HR-013).

14. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What are the password requirements?

A: A minimum of 12 characters including uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters, not matching any of the last 10 passwords used, changed every 90 days.

Q: Can I share my company password with my colleague?

A: No. Password sharing is strictly prohibited under all circumstances. If a business need for shared access exists, request a properly provisioned shared account through IT.

Q: What happens if I forget my password or get locked out?

A: After 5 failed login attempts, the account locks for 30 minutes. Contact the IT Helpdesk for an immediate unlock after identity verification.

Q: How quickly is my access removed when I leave the company?

A: All system access is revoked within 4 hours of your official exit time as recorded by HR.

15. Contact Information

IT Helpdesk	it.support@tcs-internal.com Ext. 1200
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